

Top 10 games this week · for Notre Dame fans

Week 1 · 2026 season · data Sep 3 · SP+ 2026
75% to make the 12-team field · proj. 10.3-1.7

YOUR GAME · SUN, SEP 6 · 1930 ET · NBC

Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5

Win and Notre Dame's playoff odds are 76.8%; lose and they're 63.2%. A 13.6-point swing, the biggest thing on this page by far.

Ranked by leverage · how much the result moves Notre Dame's playoff odds, discounted by how unlikely the swing is · the boxed team is the one to pull for

1	Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN	Leverage 55	Impact 42
	#19 SMU (52%) at Florida State (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5		
	A SMU win happens 52% of the time and is worth 0.27 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.7%)		
	Mostly because SMU is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 12); the better their record, the more your result against them counts (proj. 8 wins); also Florida State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.		
2	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ABC	Leverage 27	Impact 23
	Baylor (32%) at Auburn (68%) Auburn -7.5 · O/U 59.5		
	A Baylor win happens 32% of the time and is worth 0.15 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Auburn is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 5% of seasons).		
3	Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX	Leverage 26	Impact 54
	Fresno State (10%) at #14 USC (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5		
	A Fresno St win happens 10% of the time and is worth 0.35 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.1% vs 74.8%)		
	Because USC is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 14% of seasons).		
4	Sun, Sep 6 · 1600 ET · NBC	Leverage 19	Impact 45
	Washington State (9%) at #17 Washington (91%) Washington -23.5 · O/U 51.5		
	A Wash St win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.29 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.1% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Washington is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 13% of seasons).		
5	Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · NBC	Leverage 19	Impact 58
	Western Michigan (6%) at #16 Michigan (94%) Michigan -27.5 · O/U 49.5		
	A W Michigan win happens 6% of the time and is worth 0.38 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.2% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Michigan is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).		
6	Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ABC	Leverage 18	Impact 40
	East Carolina (9%) at #13 Alabama (91%) Alabama -28.5 · O/U 52.5		
	A ECU win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.26 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Alabama is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).		
7	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · FS1	Leverage 17	Impact 62
	Marshall (5%) at #18 Penn State (95%) Penn State -23.5 · O/U 52.5		
	A Marshall win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.40 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.2% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Penn State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).		
8	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ESPN	Leverage 13	Impact 52
	Texas State (5%) at #5 Texas (95%) Texas -29.5 · O/U 59.5		
	A Texas St win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.34 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.1% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Texas is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 15% of seasons).		
9	Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ESPN	Leverage 13	Impact 17
	Oregon State (18%) at #23 Houston (82%) Houston -21 · O/U 49.5		
	A Oregon St win happens 18% of the time and is worth 0.11 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Houston is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 6% of seasons).		
10	Sat, Sep 5 · 1945 ET · SEC Network	Leverage 10	Impact 26
	Florida Atlantic (8%) at Florida (92%) Florida -26.5 · O/U 59.5		
	A FAU win happens 8% of the time and is worth 0.17 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.8%)		
	Because Florida is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 8% of seasons).		